Client Onboarding SOP & Checklist

Standard operating procedure for starting a new remote support engagement

Purpose

Ensure every new engagement starts with clear scope, access, communication rules, and a first deliverable date — reducing ambiguity for both sides.

When to use

After verbal or written agreement to start, before the first billable task is accepted.

Steps

1. Confirm scope in writing

One-page summary: services included, services excluded, expected weekly hours or project milestones, and success criteria for the first two weeks.

2. Collect access & tools

Shared drive / Notion / project board links, brand assets if content work, data sample if cleanup work. Log access in a private tracker; never store passwords in email.

3. Agree communication cadence

Primary channel (email / Slack / other), response-time expectation, and weekly status format (short written note vs. call).

4. Define first deliverable

Concrete output and due date within 5–7 days. Example: cleaned sample sheet, research brief outline, or content calendar draft.

5. Send kickoff confirmation

Reply that restates scope, first deliverable, and how blockers will be flagged. Attach this checklist if useful to the client.

6. Run quality checklist on first delivery

Requirements met · accuracy checked · handoff is readable by someone who was not in the kickoff conversation.

Kickoff checklist (printable)

- ■ Scope one-pager agreed and filed
- ■ Access list completed (tools, folders, contacts)
- ■ Communication channel and cadence confirmed
- ■ First deliverable named with due date
- ■ Kickoff confirmation email sent
- ■ Private notes started (preferences, timezone, do-not-do list)

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